

Peer Response

by [Abdulrahman Alhashmi](#) - Saturday, 13 December 2025, 8:10 PM

Your post nails it: ethical risks go beyond fake data to include biased analysis that shapes the story. I agree. The real line is clear. Exploratory work counts as valid. But label it as such. Report it next to the main planned analysis.

Two steps would sharpen Abi's methods. They would curb misuse too.

First, fix the analysis plan fast.

Pre-register key outcomes. List model picks, exclusions, and p-value cut-offs.

This curbs researcher freedom. That freedom can tweak results to seem strong (Wicherts et al., 2016; Nosek et al., 2018). Big reviews prove the point. P-hacking shows up near standard cut-offs. It warps what seems solid (Head et al., 2015).

Second, report results tough to pick from.

Split them. Put primary first, exploratory last.

Show effect sizes and confidence intervals. Skip sole focus on p-values.

Share code that runs. Add a brief note for non-experts: "What this does not prove."

This meets standards for honest stats work (Royal Statistical Society, 2014).

On law and public effects, health claims by food makers face rules. They must rest on full proof, not slanted views (Regulation (EC) No 1924/2006). False food info risks UK law breaks too (Food Safety Act 1990, s.15). If Abi spots likely misuse, raise it with leaders. Alert a regulator if needed. That serves the public good.

References

Food Safety Act 1990 (UK), s.15.

Head, M.L. et al. (2015) 'The Extent and Consequences of P-Hacking in Science', PLOS Biology, 13(3).

Nosek, B.A. et al. (2018) 'The preregistration revolution', Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 115(11).

Regulation (EC) No 1924/2006 on nutrition and health claims made on foods (2006).

Royal Statistical Society (2014) Code of Conduct.

Wicherts, J.M. et al. (2016) 'Degrees of Freedom in Planning, Running, Analyzing, and Reporting Psychological Studies', Frontiers in Psychology, 7.

by [Abdulrahman Alhashmi](#) - Saturday, 13 December 2025, 8:39 PM

Farhad, your post marks a sharp divide between fair analysis and biased analysis. That split holds real weight. Even if Abi leaves the data set fixed, his picks of models, sub-group tests, or end points that favour Whizzz can still warp the evidence. This fuels p-hacking and researcher choice freedom. Such loose options craft key results without fake data (Ioannidis, 2005; Simmons, Nelson and Simonsohn, 2011).

I share your view on work duties. Abi can't curb the maker's ads. He can, though, shape his report's clearness and fullness. This asks for pre-set main outcomes and plans. It calls for full show of set tests. Split probe results from firm ones. Share doubt in plain words non-experts won't twist (ACM, 2023; Nosek et al., 2018).

Your call for outside checks stands firm. I build on it. Abi can seek review of public sums by a free stats expert. He can skip ad-style top lines that skip risks or gaps.

One query: If data point to harm, does Abi file it as standard client work? Or as public good that needs steps past the maker?

References

ACM (2023) Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct.

Ioannidis, J.P.A. (2005) 'Why most published research findings are false', PLoS Medicine, 2(8).

Nosek, B.A. et al. (2018) 'The preregistration revolution', PNAS, 115(11), pp. 2600–2606.

Simmons, J.P., Nelson, L.D. and Simonsohn, U. (2011) 'False-positive psychology', Psychological Science, 22(11), pp. 1359–1366.

Peer Response

by [Abdulrahman Alhashmi](#) - Sunday, 14 December 2025, 8:30 AM

Your post sets a sharp divide between fair analytical choices and biased reporting. That split counts a lot here. Abi may test other models. But he needs discipline: state the main question first. Split firm tests from trial ones. Share all results, not just the best fits. This matches "researcher degrees of freedom" that boost false hits if hidden (Simmons, Nelson and Simonsohn, 2011).

Abi must share doubts, flaws, and risks in clear words. Not just back notes. He owes this duty for all good and bad tests. ASA rules stress openness, repeat tests, and true result shows.

Law and society raise the bar past firm sales plans. Half reports can spark bad buyer choices and harm. In UAE, Federal Law No. 10 of 2015 guards food safety for health along the chain. Work codes like BCS stress public good and honesty. The back steps up if harm looms clear.

If Abi picks sweet spots, try these: one full report with bold key facts. Set publish rules ahead. Use ethics paths in groups. If real harm sticks, tell a watchdog. That holds up.

References

American Statistical Association (ASA) (2018) Ethical Guidelines for Statistical Practice. Available at: <https://www.amstat.org/docs/default-source/amstat-documents/EthicalGuidelines.pdf> (Accessed: 14 December 2025).

BCS (2022) Code of Conduct for BCS Members. Available at: <https://www.bcs.org/media/2211/bcs-code-of-conduct.pdf> (Accessed: 14 December 2025).

Simmons, J.P., Nelson, L.D. and Simonsohn, U. (2011) 'False-Positive Psychology: Undisclosed Flexibility in Data Collection and Analysis Allows Presenting Anything as Significant', *Psychological Science*, 22(11), pp. 1359–1366. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.1177/0956797611417632> (Accessed: 14 December 2025).

United Arab Emirates (2015) Federal Law No. (10) of 2015 Concerning the Food Safety. Available at: <https://uaelegislation.gov.ae/en/legislations/1161/download> (Accessed: 14 December 2025).

by [Abdulrahman Alhashmi](#) - Sunday, 14 December 2025, 9:21 AM

Tasnika, I agree with your stress on openness. The key ethical problem is not extra tests, but choosing them to shape a tale. Abi can try other models, but just for solid science, not sales. A simple fix: plan the analyses first. Report all planned outcomes. Label any extra results clearly. Add effect sizes, uncertainties, and limits.

Abi must share good and bad findings if public health faces risk. Hiding harm makes a false claim. This fits code rules: avoid harm, speak truth on evidence, put public good first (ACM, 2018; BCS, 2022).

Abi holds no fault for all later misuse. Still, he owns risks he could see. If he spots hype risk, wise steps work: offer a brief summary that stops selective picks without false claims. Ask for links to the full report in public posts. Keep records of all talks. If the firm seeks a biased spin, act: tap internal ethics boards, work review steps, or alert regulators. UK law guards whistle-blowers for public gain (UK Parliament, 1998).

Food laws pose risks for false claims or unsafe sales (UK Parliament, 1990; European Union, 2011).

References

ACM (2018) ACM Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct. Available at: <https://www.acm.org/code-of-ethics> (Accessed: 14 December 2025).

BCS (2022) BCS Code of Conduct (Version 8). Available at: <https://www.bcs.org/media/2211/bcs-code-of-conduct.pdf> (Accessed: 14 December 2025).

European Union (2011) Regulation (EU) No 1169/2011 on the provision of food information to consumers. Available at: <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2011/1169/oj/eng> (Accessed: 14 December 2025).

UK Parliament (1990) Food Safety Act 1990. Available at: <https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/1990/16/contents> (Accessed: 14 December 2025).

UK Parliament (1998) Public Interest Disclosure Act 1998. Available at: <https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/1998/23/contents> (Accessed: 14 December 2025).